PLACE Making Team Aboriculture

Development Management Consultation Response

Date: 23 September 2024

Reference:	Site:	Proposal:	Case Officer:
S/RES/24/0923	Land At Parcels R8 And R9 (East And West Of Old Vicarage Lane) Land North Of A420 New Eastern Villages, South Marston Swindon	Erection of 134 dwellings and provision of public open space with associated infrastructure and earthworks (layout, scale, appearance and landscaping) - Reserved Matters from previous outline permission S/OUT/13/1555.	Ed Snook
Summary of response			
		No Comment/No Objection	☐
		Information required	☒
		Objection - changes required	☒
		Objection in principle	☐
Executive Summary			

Full Comments

The application is accompanied by a suite of landscape plans (Green Landscape Studio drg nos. CB_L_86_263_R8-R9_1500 to 1506, all Rev D), cross-sectional plans for tree pit design (Green Landscape Studio drg nos. CB_L_86_263_R8-R9_1700 and CB_L_86_263_R8-R9_1701), a planning layout (Cooper Baillie drg no. CB_86_263_R8-R9_001 Rev C), a nine part Design and Access Statement (Cooper Baillie Limited ref CB_86_263 and dated August 2024) and assorted other documentation relating to the layout. A pre-application enquiry was submitted (ref S/PM2/24/0402) and I made several comments relating to particular arboricultural elements and most remain unaddressed.

The Oak to the east of plot 4 is shown as retained on the landscape drawings but has been omitted from the S38 and road geometry drawings. The engineering drawings need to show the position of the tree in relation to the highway works. The layout is likely to have an impact on some of the protected trees, notably the Oaks adjacent to Old Vicarage Lane, due to the proximity of development and proposed highway works. I previously raised this issue and also requested that the reserved matters application include a tree survey and assessment of the arboricultural implications, to accord with BS5837:2012. Despite advising that this is necessary, to assist in the assessment of the application, no specific arboricultural reports have been submitted for consideration. It is noted that the planning layout shows an

indicative root protection area (RPA) around the trees, but it is apparent that the constraint of the existing road on the rooting systems has not been considered. A tree constraints plan needs to be submitted which adheres to the formula set out in the British Standard for accurate depiction of a remodelled RPA. Only then will it be possible to assess the potential impacts on the existing trees from plot 1 and the access road created for plots 1-5.

I previously commented on the dearth of species within the proposed landscape scheme that could be classed as long lived. Whilst there have been some changes within the plant schedule, the revised schedule retains many species that offer only a very domesticated scale of size at maturity. As previously, I acknowledge that the confines of space within the parcels area dictates the species choice, but there are areas that should be prioritised for inclusion with larger species at maturity. The character of Old Vicarage Lane is hedgerow-lined with existing intermittent Oaks and, by opting for hybridised or smaller urban species to be included adjacent to the road, this character will be irrevocably diminished. There is widespread use of Hornbeam, which could readily be substituted, along with the heavy inclusion of hybridised Rowan where the selected use of Oaks should be prioritised.

I endorse the comments of the council's landscape officer in terms of species selection, location and density.